



## Connective Tissue Graft

**Purpose:** Surgical procedure in which connective tissue is taken from under the surface of the palate and placed over an exposed tooth root to treat gum recession.

**First 24–48 Hours:**

- Mild bleeding, swelling, and discomfort at both the donor and graft sites are common.
- Apply ice packs for 15–20 minutes at a time during the first day.
- Keep head elevated while resting.

**Pain & Sensitivity:**

- Take prescribed pain medications and antibiotics exactly as directed.
- Mild sensitivity to hot, cold, or pressure is normal for several weeks.

**Oral Hygiene:**

- Do not brush or floss near the graft site until instructed by your dentist.
- Use prescribed antimicrobial rinses to maintain cleanliness.

**Diet:**

- Eat only soft foods for at least 1 week.
- Avoid hot, spicy, crunchy, or sticky foods.

**Special Precautions:**

- Avoid stretching your lip or cheek to look at the graft.
- Do not smoke or drink alcohol during healing.

**Follow-Up:**

- Attend follow-up appointments to assess graft success.
- Contact your dentist if bleeding persists, swelling worsens after 3 days, or signs of infection occur.